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Building Hope, Changing Lives Every Day

Our goal is helping communities around South Saskatchewan with care and zero judgment. Our goal is to make our community a safer, healthier, and more welcoming place for everyone.

What We Do

AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan (APSS) is a community-based non-profit registered charitable organization focused on preventing HIV/AIDS and Substance Use harms.

Our goal is to provide those living with HIV/AIDS and Hepatitis C (HCV) and those at risk of contracting infection and suffering overdoses, with relevant and current information and support services.

Our community in action

Here's a quick look at what we do.

Support When You Need It Most

Comprehensive HIV/AIDS Care & Support

Health Support

Access to testing, treatment, and medical care.

Counseling

Emotional support for individuals and families.

Prevention

Awareness programs to stop HIV spread.

Impact-Driven Community Initiatives

Our programs are designed to create awareness, improve health, and empower communities affected by HIV/AIDS.

Community Care

Health & Wellness Outreach

Awareness Drives

HIV Prevention Campaigns

Support Programs

Care & Counseling Services

AIDS PROGRAM SOUTH SASKATCHEWAN INC.

HOME | ABOUT US | RESEARCH | EDUCATION | GET HELP | GET INVOLVED | CONTACT US

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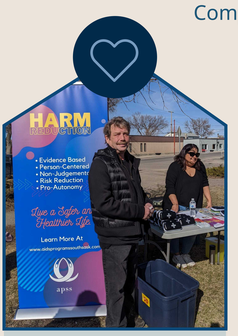

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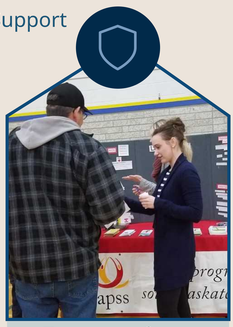

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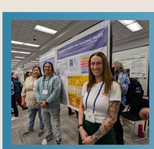

Awareness Drives

HIV Prevention Campaigns

Support Programs

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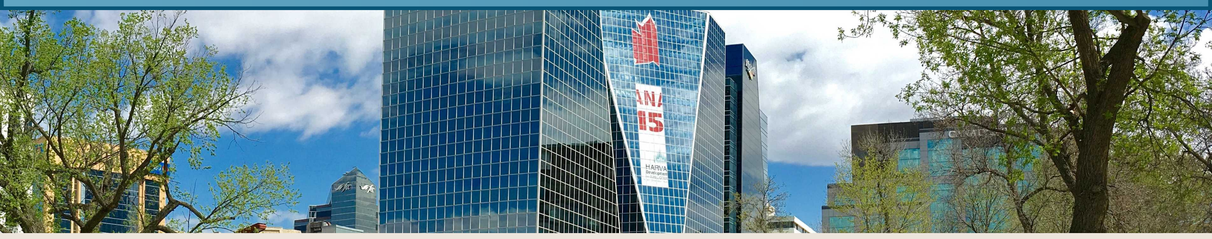


Our Journey, Our Impact

Builds a healthier and more supportive community together

Founded by gay men

During the HIV/AIDS crisis of 1980s

Proudly serving diverse communities across Southern Saskatchewan today, including First Nations, Métis and Inuit peoples.

What We Do

AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan (APSS) is a community-based non-profit registered charitable organization focused on preventing HIV/AIDS and Substance Use harms. Our goal is to provide those living with HIV/AIDS and Hepatitis C (HCV) and those at risk of contracting infection and suffering overdoses with relevant information and support services.

Our Programs and Services:

The Client Care program works directly with people living with HIV/AIDS and substance use disorders. Our Client Care Coordinator works with individuals to determine personal needs and together design supportive plans which may include: practical needs (food, clothing), health services (transportation, medication, and nutrition), and support (counseling, support, and treatment).

The Peer Support program offers support for people living with HIV and those at risk for HIV as well as people living with substance use disorders.

Harm reduction programs include Needle Exchange services and condom distribution. We distribute HIV self test kits, drug testing strips and a range of harm reduction supplies through the needle exchange.

Education services offer free or subsidized HIV/HCV/STI presentations to schools, community centers, First Nati ons communities, and correctional facilities. We provide Naloxone training and distribute kits.

We provide practicums for nursing, mental health and addictions, and social work students and Community Learning Experience for medical students. Practicum students run the Tender Loving Care (TLC) program — offering healthy snacks, education on health/social issues each week, and a quick health checkup (blood pressure/blood sugar).

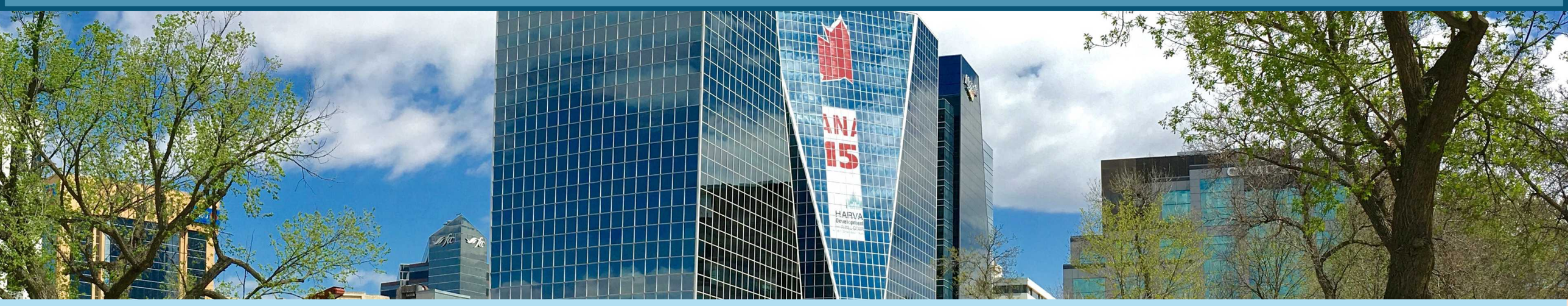
Our web based reportneedles.ca is a key public safety needle pick up service in Regina which also generates community needle incidence data for research and targeted harm reduction interventions.

Our Story Continues With You
Explore ways to Get Involved in our community

Get Involved

APSS serves the larger community of Regina and Southern Saskatchewan in all HIV-related matters. APSS is a registered non-profit charity and is funded in part by the Saskatchewan Health Authority, Saskatchewan Health and the Government of Canada, as well as corporate sponsorships and donations.

Though APSS was originally established in 1985 as a support group for gay men in Regina, it has over the years grown into a multi-program, multi-staff organization with the goal of reducing HIV, HCV and Sexually Transmitted & Blood Borne Infections (STBBIs) to provide support for people living with HIV/AIDS.



APSS

A story of community, compassion and commitment.

Our History

Significant Events

1985

Several concerned citizens formed a peer support group for HIV and began to lobby the provincial government for funding.

1986

AIDS Regina was incorporated on January 27th.

1987

Created the People with AIDS Heath Care Fund which posthumously became the Jerome Nagel Health Care Fund and the Ric Ranger Emergency Living Fund (now the Ric Ranger/Jerome Nagel Wellness Fund). This fund ensures that those living with HIV/AIDS are able to live healthy lives.

2000

AIDS Regina changed their name to AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan as well as opened up services and programs to reach Southern Saskatchewan

2001

APSS started The Queen City Needle Exchange Program.

AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan

AIDS Regina was the eventual result of several concerned citizens forming a peer support group for HIV. At that time, support consisted of an AIDS Hotline and a safe sex education program for gay men.

We were founded by four men:

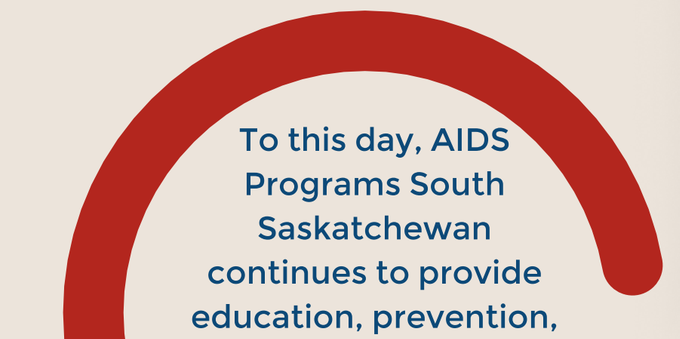
Nials Clausson, Jerome Nagel, Don McGuire, and Roger Lagace.

To educate the public about HIV/AIDS and stopping the spread of the virus, AIDS Regina was supported by the arts community and Oscar Wilde & Company, a theatre group in Regina that was the only gay theatre company on the Canadian prairies. Its primary mandate was to produce plays about AIDS and gay issues, as well as other important social and political issues.

Back when we were founded, HIV stigma was at a record high due to the lack of understanding of how HIV was spread. People facing the terrifying reality of AIDS were alone. When people were confined to hospitals to live out their days, our founders snuck in alcohol so they could have one last drink with a friend. AIDS Regina looked past the stigma and was there for them at the end stages of their life.

To this day, AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan continues to provide education, prevention, and support services for the people of Regina and Southern Saskatchewan.

United Beyond Time



APSS is the repository for a collection of quilts made in honour of community members who lost their lives to AIDS – among them our founder, Jerome Nagel.

View our Memorial Quilts →

Our Supporters

Stronger Together

We are grateful for the individuals, organizations and partners who help to achieve our works.

Our Community of Supporters

- All Nations Hope Network
- Carmichael Outreach
- City of Regina
- First Nation's University
- Four Directions Health Community Centre
- Infectious Disease Clinic
- Moose Jaw HIV Strategy
- Newo Yotina Friendship Centre
- Paul Dojack Youth Centre
- Prairie Harm Reduction
- Prairie Pride
- Prairie South School Division
- Planned Parenthood Regina
- Queen City Pride
- Regal Social Association of Regina (RSAR)
- Regina Catholic Schools
- Regina Public Schools
- Regina Provincial Correctional Centre
- Regina & District Food Bank
- Regina Open Door Society
- Sask Polytechnic LPN Nursing Program
- Saskatchewan HIV Collaborative
- Street Workers' Advocacy Project
- University of Regina/Saskatchewan Polytechnic Collaborative Nursing Program
- University of Regina Social Work Program
- University of Saskatchewan College of Medicine
- University of Saskatchewan Nursing Program
- UR Pride Centre for Sexuality and Diversity

Our Funders

Public Health Agency of Canada / Agence de la santé publique du Canada

Saskatchewan Health Authority

Saskatchewan Ministry of Health

Community Initiatives Fund

ViiV Healthcare

TD Bank

University of Regina SHRF Saskatchewan Health Research Foundation

REGINA

CIHR IRSC Canadian Institutes of Health Research / Instituts de recherche en santé du Canada

Our National Partners

CATIE

CANADIAN AIDS SOCIETY / SOCIÉTÉ CANADIENNE DU SIDA

Together we create healthier and stronger communities.

Join Our Team!

Make A Difference With US

Bring your skills, compassion, and ideas to work that supports our community.

Why Work With Us?

Meaningful Work

Make a real impact in people's lives.

Team Support

Work with caring, respectful and passionate people. We celebrate diversity and belonging.

Professional Growth

Build your skills and advance your career.

Current Opportunities

Explore our open positions here!!

Community Health Worker

Regina, SK

Full-Time

Support individuals and families through education, outreach and referrals to community services.

View Details ⟶

Community Health Worker

Regina, SK

Full-Time

Support individuals and families through education, outreach and referrals to community services.

View Details ⟶

Community Health Worker

Regina, SK

Full-Time

Support individuals and families through education, outreach and referrals to community services.

View Details ⟶

We also welcome volunteers!!
Your time and skills can make a big difference.

Explore Volunteering⟶

" The work we do is only possible because of people who care."

Remembering Lives, Honouring Stories, Keeping Memories Together

The Memorial Quilts are a collection of handmade quilts that honour the community members who lost their lives to AIDS.

Each quilt tells a unique story.

In 1987, in the midst of the AIDS crisis, the NAMES Project was created to commemorate the lives of people who had died of AIDS. A collection of cloth panels, designed as memorials to specific individuals who had died of AIDS, were gathered in a permanent monument called The AIDS Memorial Quilt.

Although it's difficult to believe today, in the beginning of the AIDS crisis, many people who died of AIDS-related causes did not receive funerals--due to both the social stigma of AIDS and the outright refusal by many funeral homes and cemeteries to handle the remains of the deceased.

Lacking a memorial service or grave site, the Memorial Quilt was often the only opportunity survivors had to remember and celebrate the lives of their loved ones.

APSS is very proud to be the repository for a collection of quilts made in honour of several community members who lost their lives to AIDS.

The Anonymous Quilt

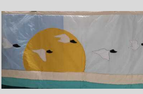
The Anonymous Quilt commemorates all citizens of Saskatchewan who died of AIDS, but who do not wish for whatever reason, to be named.

This quilt also commemorates those in Saskatchewan, prior to 1983 who died of AIDS, yet were never diagnosed. Before 1983, due to a lack of medical research and information about HIV/AIDS, not everyone was correctly diagnosed.

The shape of the quilt represents the province. The colour green is significant, representing Saskatchewan's agriculture. It's two major rivers, the North and South Saskatchewan, are also represented.

There are a number of cities, towns, villages, and reserves represented on the quilt. None of these centres were picked to draw specific attention to them, other than to show that HIV/AIDS can occur everywhere.

Future - New Dawn



Quilts created by the Gay and Lesbian Centre of Regina (GLCR). Depending on how the quilts are arranged, it can show the geese flying to Saskatchewan or away from.

People that were diagnosed with HIV/AIDS were returning home to Saskatchewan to die after being given a "death sentence". These quilts symbolize the people being geese returning home, or taking flight one last time.

Jerome Francis Nagel

September 7, 1958 – August 6, 1990

Excerpts from Jerome's memorial, published in the December 1990 issue of AIDS Regina newsletter:

"It is difficult to write about someone who fits many categories, all of which are special to the people who knew him. He was, as is in the memory of many, a special friend. This individual touched many lives with his sensitivity, positive attitude and outlook on life, his caring ways, concern, and love for others. He used his illness to learn from it and gather insight into himself. This became a period of growth for him. The knowledge he gained, he passed on to others and became an inspiration for those who have AIDS and those working in AIDS. In life, Jerome had many accomplishments. He was an accomplished artist and gardener; he had a love of Japanese gardening, his yard took on some of these characteristics. His artwork was unique and original. It was haunting and compelling. Yet it sent a clear message on inner spirituality.".

His art, influenced by Japanese culture, has been displayed at the Dunlop Art Gallery.

Jerome's quilt is symbolic of his personality and his artistic expression. As his major medium was the utilization of the colour black, the background of the quilt honours this theme.

The three stripes down one side represents a stylized, muted Japanese rainbow. Along with the rainbow, the crystals which give off rays of colour, are symbolic of Jerome's warm and radiant personality.

His name and the years of birth and death are done in his handwriting. Jerome used three different signatures throughout his life; this is one of them.

The "Chop" above his name is his name in Mandarin. In Mandarin, Jerome is translated into "artist". Jerome signed his letters, not only with his signature, but also with his Chop.

Jerome was a self-taught graphic artist. To his credit, are the logos of the Regina Public Library, AIDS Regina, the Gay Community of Regina, and Laser Acoustics.

His work in AIDS included: being a founding member of AIDS Regina, a past board member for AIDS Regina, a past member of AIDS Regina Advisory Board, creator of the People with AIDS Heath Care Fund, setting up the first HIV positive/PWA Support Group, and co-founding member of the People Living with AIDS Network of Saskatchewan.

For his dedication and service, Jerome was the recipient of AIDS Regina's Community Service Award in May, 1990.

After his death, he was posthumously honoured, unanimously by the board of AIDS Regina, to the People with AIDS Health Fund renamed in his honour.

It is now known as the "Jerome Nagel Health Care Fund".

Ric Mervin Ranger

May 1, 1960 – September 22, 1989

Ric Ranger was one of the first members of AIDS Regina's HIV Positive Support Group. He also attended Alcoholics Anonymous (AA) and Narcotics Anonymous (NA). His dedication to these groups was renowned, right up to his death. He was also one of the first people to access AIDS Regina's Support Services.

Ric liked support groups. They fulfilled his need to belong, to be accepted, loved, and affirmed as an individual.

For these support groups, Ric offered something in return. Besides his devotion, he was an example for others to follow. His was a success story.

During his life, Ric was addicted to alcohol and drugs. Many times he tried to stop. Sometimes he would be successful for a few days, a few weeks, or a few months.

Ric's success started when he joined AA and NA. These organizations and his own desire gave him the power and commitment to stop his alcohol and substance abuse.

When Ric was diagnosed with HIV, he could have returned to his former life. The same could have happened when he was diagnosed with AIDS. In both instances, Ric showed outstanding courage and strength through a strong spirituality that did not waver. Ric stated his life was strengthened through his involvement in AA, NA, and the HIV Positive Support Group.

Ric grew up in Marcellin, Saskatchewan. He was Cree and was born in Northern Saskatchewan. At aged two, Ric was adopted by a French foster family.

During his life, Ric worked in the oil fields of Alberta, resided in Vancouver, before making Regina his home. In Regina, Ric operated his own carpentry business and was at his happiest when he was doing carpentry work.

The colours of Ric's quilt are black, white, yellow, and blue. Unknown to the designer of this quilt, these are the colours of the Northern Cree. It was as if Ric's hands were guiding the designer.

The colours and design tell of Ric's battle. The black is symbolic to his addictions, the night time of his life. The black jagged line represents his efforts to stop his addictions, which were not always successful.

The blue (the sky) along with the yellow (the sun) represents the growth in his life when he overcame his addictions. It further represents the spiritual element he found within himself that was to sustain him right through his illness with AIDS.

The beaded wheel of life pays homage to Ric's native ancestry, heritage, and culture.

In the last year of Ric's life, his financial situation was beset by problems. He was not able to work. His basic living expenses outweighed the income he was receiving. To assist Ric, AIDS Regina established a fund to supplement his costs.

As this fund was set up for Ric and later, fulfilled a need for others, it became a permanent part of AIDS Regina's Support Services.

In honour of Ric, this fund was named posthumously, "The Ric Ranger Emergency Living Fund". It is a living memorial to his courage and conviction.

Dean Leslie Brown

April 30, 1961 – July 16, 1991

Since September 28, 1983, Rod and Dean were a couple. There was no other way to describe their relationship. For the people who knew them, it was inconceivable to think of Dean without Rod or Rod without Dean. Friends do not talk about one of them or reminisce about the other without thinking of both of them. They were a unit.

A good description of Rod and Dean was found in a letter written by a good friend of theirs to Rod's mother on July 21, 1991:

"One of the first things that struck me was the love that they shared for each other. They complimented each other. Rod was the more outgoing, the decision maker when it came to entertainment and volunteering for AIDS Regina. Dean was the quiet support in the background.

Rod, when he made a commitment, jumped in with both feet. Dean kept everything going with his sense of humour. Dean's humour, to say the least, different. If you didn't know Dean, you would think he was being sarcastic. After getting to know him, you enjoyed his humour and were always waiting for what would come out next. That included his pet name for Rod. He called him "Turtle Toes" as he said Rod's toes reminded him of the toes you would find on a turtle...if a turtle had toes. Rod called Dean, Dino.

In closing, I will say that I learned a lot from Dean and Rod. They taught me a lot about relationships. About a relationship of commitment, love, and caring. It was very nice that I was allowed to share this with them, even though it was for a short period of time (3 months)."

As it was in their lives together, so it was in their deaths. Their families had their ashes interred together in Calgary and they share the same bronze plaque.

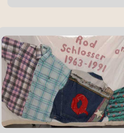
In the last months of their lives, Dean and Rod were in the Plains Health Centre, in single rooms across the hall from each other.

Medically, Rod should have died before Dean as he was much sicker. Many times, Dean had said that he hoped he would not be left alone. Rod held out so that Dean could die first. Rod followed Dean twenty hours later.

Two quilts were created for Rod and Dean: the Rod and Dean Memorial Quilt and the Rod and Dean Signature Quilt.

Rodney Russel Schlosser

December 9, 1963 – July 17, 1991



The Rod and Dean Memorial Quilt

This quilt is covered with Dean's and Rod's clothing. The fact that the shirts join together at the sleeves, too, symbolizes Rod and Dean's partnership in life.

It was difficult to pick out clothing for Dean and Rod. Since they were the same size and build, they often wore each other's clothing.

The two shirts hemmed together on the left side of the quilt is Rod's. The blue jean jacket, t-shirt, and bandanna are Dean's. Dean never went anywhere without a bandanna around his neck.

The Rod and Dean Signature Quilt

This quilt was prepared for Dean's and Rod's memorial service held in Regina on July 31, 1991. The purpose of this quilt was to allow people that Rod and Dean's lives had touched to write a personal message to them as a way of saying goodbye.

A memorial service was held by their families at an earlier date in Calgary.

Rod and Dean were both active at AIDS Regina, the HIV Caucus of Regina, and the People Living with AIDS Network of Saskatchewan. For their contributions, they were awarded posthumously, AIDS Regina's Community Service Award on June 8, 1992.

David John Fehr

March 31, 1956 – April 11, 1989

David was a special man. One realizes this when reading his obituary which stated that he was a son, a brother, an uncle, and a friend. David was all this and much, much more.

David had an outgoing and friendly personality. He was interested in others, and this showed through to those who became his friends.

The writer of this piece had the good fortune to meet David in the early 1970's while they were both employed at Robert Simpsons in the Men's Fashion Department.

"David and I became work friends. We spent lunch and coffee breaks together. It was during these lunch breaks that I was introduced to David's passion – music. After we ate, we spent our lunch breaks in record stores.

David loved music of every type, and he had a vast collection of records and tapes ranging from rock, easy listening, country and western, jazz, and folk music to classical. Although David's passion was music, he did not play an instrument, except for the drums in band while attending school. Unfortunately, after David left Robert Simpsons, we lost contact."

David's quilt speaks to his love of music and his personality. The musical staff with the notes on the quilt is not taken from any specific tune. It simply acknowledges this musical interest.

One with musical knowledge will notice that some of the stems on the notes are facing in the wrong direction, that they should be going down when they are facing up. This was done in error.

Yet, for David, this is perfectly correct, for he did not read a note of music and would not recognize this error. It would not have made any difference to him.

His was the love of listening to music and enjoying the great pleasure it has brought since music was first composed.

The background colour of light blue on the quilt, plus the yellow lettering, represents David's warm personality.

In the mid 1970's, David moved to Vancouver where he resided until his death. In Vancouver, he was employed by the Royal Bank. He was also an active volunteer, especially with the Canadian Cancer Society.

Research

APSS has already partnered with the University of Regina in order to combat this issue, the full statement is available just to the right of this paragraph where you can read the full statement about the partnership of APSS and U of R, and what is being done in order to combat this issue further.

News Release:
University of Regina

APSS also is aiming to reduce the amount of used needles in public communities by locating them throughout the city by the reports of the people who find them. If you find a needle in public you can report it by going to reportneedles.ca after which it will be picked up by a person who has the proper tools to do so. All it takes is for someone

reportneedles.ca

Since 1985, APSS has been helping people living with and affected by HIV/AIDS. We are a community-based non-profit registered charitable organization. Our goal is to provide people living with HIV/AIDS, Hepatitis C (HCV), and other Sexually Transmitted and Blood Borne Infections (STBBIs) and those at risk of contracting the viruses with relevant and current information and support services.

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We at APSS have plenty of resources to educate those who might not know much about COVID-19 and MPOX. If you wish to learn more about COVID-19 and MPOX you can also click on the hearts to go straight to all the research and guidelines we have regarding COVID-19 and MPOX.

COVID-19 Factsheet

MPOX Factsheet

Including how to go about protecting yourself and others surrounding you, otherwise the link to the research is also included in our header near the top of the page

Cree Resources

We Are Proud to Translate Our Literature into Cree

tânisi kahkiyaw ayiwak!

We are proud to offer a growing collection of APSS resources translated into Cree. These translations were completed by Véronique Mireault, an Indigenous Studies graduate from the University of Regina, with the invaluable support and guidance of Solomon Ratt.

We are grateful for their contributions in helping make harm reduction and health information more accessible to Cree-speaking individuals and communities.

Currently Available

APSS Service Brochure

Overview of APSS programs and services in Cree.

Click to Download

Phoning 911

A guide to calling emergency services, in Cree.

Click to Download

The Good Samaritan Law

Know your rights when helping someone in need, in Cree.

Click to Download

HIV 101

Essential HIV information and prevention basics, in Cree.

Click to Download

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Anyone At-Risk Peer Support

Elder Deanna Keewatin
Anyone At-Risk Elder

This team is supported by the excellent work of practicum students from the Sask Polytechnic LPN Nursing program, the University of Saskatchewan Nursing program, University of Regina/Saskatchewan Polytechnic Collaborative Nursing Program, University of Regina Social Work program, and the University of Saskatchewan College of Medicine.

FAQs

What is HIV?

HIV stands for Human Immunodeficiency Virus. This virus attacks the immune system, which normally defends the body against disease. Without treatment, the immune system weakens, leading to serious illnesses. The most severe stage is AIDS.

How is HIV transmitted?

HIV spreads through direct contact with blood or body fluids from an infected person. Main transmission routes include unprotected sex and sharing needles for drug injection. HIV cannot spread through handshakes, hugging, kissing, coughs, sneezes, or contact with insects.

What is harm reduction?

Harm reduction is an evidence-based, client-centered approach that aims to reduce harmful consequences associated with certain behaviours. APSS uses harm reduction by meeting people where they are, offering non-judgmental access to peer support, medical services, and social resources.

How do I get tested for HIV?

APSS offers free and confidential HIV testing. Our nurse is available on Tuesdays from 1:00–4:00 pm for HIV, Hepatitis A/B/C, STI, and pregnancy testing. No appointment needed. Contact us at (306) 924-8420 for more information.

What is the Needle Exchange Program?

The Queen City Needle Exchange provides sterile needles and a safe disposal location for used needles. We also offer harm reduction counselling, safer drug use education, and referrals to treatment services. Visit us during business hours or contact the Street Project Van after hours at (306) 766-7799.

How can I get involved with APSS?

There are many ways to support APSS: donate online or by cheque, volunteer at our Needle Exchange or packing parties, assist at education events, or host your own fundraiser. Contact us at (306) 924-8420 or visit our Get Involved page for more details.

What is Naloxone and where can I get it?

Naloxone (Narcan) is a temporary opioid overdose antidote that reverses effects within 5–10 minutes. It is non-narcotic, non-addictive, and harmless if opioids are absent. Free naloxone kits and 15-minute training are available at our office at 1325 Albert Street, Tuesday–Sunday. No appointment needed.

COVID-19

What is Coronavirus Disease or COVID-19?

Coronavirus disease (COVID-19) is caused by an infection with a virus called Severe Acute Respiratory Syndrome Coronavirus 2 or SARS-CoV-2.
COVID-19 stands for coronavirus disease of 2019 and it is a pandemic because it has spread to many different parts of the world.

Where did this virus come from?

COVID-19 was first seen in Wuhan city, Hubei province, China, in December 2019.

Coronaviruses are a large group of viruses — some coronaviruses cause illness in people and others are seen in bats, cattle, cats and camels. Rarely, an animal coronavirus may spread to people — COVID-19 is believed to have spread to humans from bats sold in a wet food market in Wuhan.

What factors can increase risk of severe COVID-19 Infection?

- Reduced immunity due to illnesses like HIV/AIDS or any other cause of reduced immunity like chemotherapy
- Other health problems like diabetes, high blood pressure, lung disease, cancer
- Older people (In the US, 8 out of 10 deaths have been in people 65 years or older: CDC)
- Crowded situations

How does COVID-19 Spread?

COVID-19 spreads from an infected person to a person without infection or even to pets through droplets (tiny drops) of secretions from the nose, mouth, throat, or lungs. Droplets are released into the air or fall on surfaces when you talk, sneeze, cough, or spit.

These droplets from a person with COVID-19 can get into your body through your mouth, nose, or eyes. Droplets with the virus may be in the air and can enter your body when you breathe in these droplets. These droplets can also be on surfaces such as door handles or other objects. From these objects, they can end up on your hands and get into your body when you touch your face.

How Can I Reduce My Risk and Prevent the Spread of COVID-19?

The best way to prevent or slow the spread is to learn as much as possible about COVID-19 virus, the disease it causes and how it spreads.

- Wash hands regularly for at least 20 seconds with soap and water
- Use disinfectant gel or solution if you do not have access to soap and water
- Do not touch your face with unwashed hands
- Maintain social distancing — stay at least 6 feet from other people
- Avoid crowds
- Wear a mask — a simple surgical mask can help prevent you from touching your nose and mouth as well as reduce the spread of droplets when you talk, sneeze or cough
- Wear protective eyewear or a visor
- Use recommended personal protective equipment (PPE) such as masks, gloves, special clothing, visors, etc. if you are caring for a person with COVID-19
- Cough into a bent elbow or tissue
- If you have a cold or flu, stay home and self isolate — reduce other people's exposure to your infection
- Follow social distancing or lockdown recommendations
- If you have symptoms of COVID-19 such as cough, fever or breathing difficulty, consult your doctor or nurse and follow all advice on isolation or quarantine, testing, and treatment
- Protect the elderly and sick from meeting anyone who has flu-like symptoms

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What Are the Signs and Symptoms of Coronavirus Infection?

Most people infected with the COVID-19 virus will experience mild to moderate flu like symptoms and may not need any treatment at all. Older people, and those with other medical problems like heart problems, diabetes, lung problems, and cancer are more likely to develop serious illness. COVID-19 symptoms include:

- Fever
- Cough
- Difficulty breathing
- Pneumonia in both lungs
- Fatigue/tiredness
- Sputum/phlegm
- Sudden loss of taste or smell
- Loss of appetite
- Muscle pains
- Runny nose
- Diarrhea
- Nausea

What Do I Do If I Have Any COVID-19 Symptoms?

Some people may not have any symptoms of COVID-19 illness at all but may be carriers and can spread the virus. That is why it's important to maintain social distancing to break the chain or slow the spread of COVID-19.

Stay home and isolate yourself to reduce the chances of spreading COVID-19 to family members or friends. Call your local health line (In Saskatchewan, call 811) to ask what you should do. If your illness is mild, find out if you can take over the counter medicines for your symptoms. If you do not feel better, your fever remains the same or increases, you have a persistent cough, difficulty breathing, or other symptoms that do not get better, please call the health line or your local hospital and arrange to be seen in a COVID clinic. Your doctor or nurse will check if you have COVID-19 symptoms or signs, order tests and advise you if you need to stay in quarantine or hospital for further treatment.

It is important to remember that most people with COVID-19 recover by themselves without any specific treatment. It may become severe only in a small number of people especially if you are older than 50 years of age, have any pre-existing conditions like diabetes, cancer or other chronic lung or heart problems.

Who Should Be Tested?

To find if you have COVID-19 infection, viral tests are used. But not everyone needs this test. Most people have mild illness and can recover at home and may not need tests or medical care. Your provincial or local health departments or your doctor or nurse practitioner will decide who needs a test for COVID-19.
If you have symptoms of COVID-19 that are not getting better, call your health line or healthcare provider.
You can also visit your local government website to look for the latest information on COVID-19 and testing.
You can use this self assessment tool to see if you need testing for COVID-19.

Who Should Be Tested?

Two kinds of tests are available for COVID-19: viral tests and antibody tests.

Viral Test:

- A viral test tells you if you have COVID-19 infection at the time of testing

Antibody Test:

- An antibody test tells you if you previously had a COVID-19 infection. It cannot show a current infection, because it can take 1–3 weeks after infection for your body's immune system to make antibodies. It is not yet known if having antibodies can protect a person from getting COVID-19 again and how long that protection will last.

Results of Tests for COVID-19:

- If you test positive for COVID-19 by a viral test, your doctor or nurse will advise you about treatment, isolation or admission to a hospital unit reserved for COVID-19 patients.
- If you test negative for COVID-19 by a viral test, it means you do not have COVID-19 at the time of testing. It does not mean you will not get COVID-19 as you can still catch the infection at any time — so it is important to remain safe.

Whether you test positive or negative for any COVID-19 test, you should always take action to protect yourself and others.

How Is Coronavirus Infection Treated?

Most people with COVID-19 illness will recover on their own. Severe or worsening symptoms may require supportive treatment in hospital, for example: medicines to control high fever or severe cough, oxygen therapy if there is low blood oxygen level, or ventilator support for breathing difficulty.

You may also receive antibiotics or antiviral medicines to treat COVID-19 infection.

If symptoms feel worse than the usual cold, see a health care provider or call Healthline at 811. If Healthline 811 asks you to visit a doctor or hospital, they will advise you about calling the hospital or clinic before you go there.

At present, there is no approved vaccine that protects against coronaviruses, including COVID-19.

Is the Treatment for Coronavirus Infection Free of Cost?

Treatment is available free for everyone diagnosed with COVID-19 as this is a public health crisis.

Is There Financial Assistance Available During This COVID-19 Pandemic?

There is financial assistance available for different situations.

Please share this information with as many people as you can to help us all stay safe! Thank you for your support.

COVID-19 Saskatchewan

Saskatchewan specific information on COVID-19

Click to Learn More

COVID-19 Saskatchewan

- COVID-19 information: Government of Canada
- WHO COVID-19 advice for public
- Getting workplace ready for COVID-19

COVID-19 Saskatchewan

Learn more about financial assistance

Click to Learn More

MPOX

What is MPox?

MPox is a rare but potentially serious viral illness. It is in the same family as Small Pox, but less severe. It is also less transmissible and not often fatal.

How is MPOX Transmitted?

- Skin-to-skin contact
- Contact with Infect objects
- Touching bodily fluids of someone who has MPOX
- Large respiratory droplets

How Can I Reduce My Risk and Prevent the Spread of MPox?

The best way to prevent or slow the spread is to learn as much as possible about MPox virus, the disease it causes and how it spreads.

- Get the vaccine
- Wear a mask & avoid close contact with infected individuals
- Limit sex partners
- Wash hands
- Disinfect objects & surfaces

Signs & Symptoms of MPox Infection

It can take up to 21 days to develop symptoms. Some people may experience all or just a few of the following:

- Fever (>38°C), chills
- Swollen lymph nodes
- Headache
- Muscle/joint pain
- Backache
- Sore throat
- Cough
- Stuffy nose
- Exhaustion
- Extreme weakness
- Rash/blisters on face, palms of the hands, & soles of the feet within 1–3 days

MPOX Brochure

More Information ↗

Blog

Most Recent Post: N/A

New Discovery: N/A

Next Event Details: N/A

Special Events: N/A

Factsheets

This is a page dedicated to the list of factsheets we have you can look into to learn more about some health risks.

COVID-19 Factsheet

Information factsheet about COVID-19 for educational purposes

Click to view

MPOX Factsheet

Information factsheet about MPOX for educational purposes

Click to view

What is HIV?

Human Immunodeficiency Virus

HIV is a virus that attacks your immune system. Your immune system is your body's built-in defense against diseases. Although your immune system is supposed to protect you from infections, HIV can sneak past it. HIV then attacks your immune system from the inside. Without HIV treatment, your immune system can become too weak to fight off serious illnesses. HIV can also damage other parts of your body. Eventually, you can become sick with life-threatening infections. These are called "opportunistic infections", meaning they take the opportunity to infect a weak immune system. This is the most serious stage of HIV infection, called AIDS.

Spread & Transmission

How is HIV Transmitted?

HIV is transmitted through direct contact with the blood or body fluid of someone who is infected with the virus.

HIV can also be passed:

- to a fetus or baby during pregnancy, birth or breastfeeding (if you are living with HIV, with proper treatment and care, you can have a HIV-negative baby)
- by sharing needles or ink to get a tattoo
- by sharing needles or jewelry to get a body piercing
- by sharing acupuncture needles

HIV cannot be passed by:

- shaking hands, working or eating with someone who has HIV
- hugs or kisses
- coughs, sneezes or spitting
- swimming pools, toilet seats or water fountains
- insects or animals

Since November 1985, all blood products in Canada are checked for HIV, to ensure that it is safe to get a blood transfusion. There is no chance of getting HIV from donating blood.
HIV is very fragile and cannot live outside of the body.

HIV can only be passed by these five body fluids:

- Blood
- Semen (including pre-cum)
- Anal fluid
- Vaginal fluid
- Breast milk

The two main ways that HIV can be passed are:

- through unprotected sex (oral, anal, vaginal)
  * Oral has a low risk of passing HIV as it is a mixture of the 5 fluids with saliva. However, oral is high risk for other STIs.
- by sharing needles or other equipment to inject drugs (including steroids or hormones)

Spread & Transmission

Signs & Symptoms

Across Canada, 1 in 5 people living with HIV have not been diagnosed. The only way to know is to get tested.
(Places to get tested in Regina: HIV/STI Testing)

To test for HIV involves having some blood taken from your arm or a couple of drops of blood taken from your finger. All HIV tests have a window period, which is the time between exposure to HIV and the point when the test can accurately detect and diagnose HIV. The window period can be as long as three months because the test only looks for HIV antibodies.

We recommend that you get tested regularly (every 5 years, when you change sexual partners, or participate in high risk activities) and know your HIV status.

PEP (Post-Exposure Prophylaxis): If you are HIV-negative and may have been exposed to HIV, you can take PEP. PEP drugs must be started as soon as possible (within 72 hours of being exposed to HIV) and need to be taken for 28 days. A person starts PEP after being exposed to HIV.

Often people who are newly HIV infected have few or no symptoms. Other times, symptoms of HIV are confused with other illnesses such as the flu. If a person were to have symptoms they would include:

- Swollen lymph nodes in the neck, groin or under the arms
- Diarrhea
- Unexplained weight loss
- Fatigue
- Fever, chills or sweats (especially at night)
- Frequent pneumonia's or shortness of breath
- Rash

Staying Safe

HIV Prevention

Protecting yourself and your sex partners:

- Condoms and lube. Use a new condom every time you have sex. This will help protect you from HIV and other STIs (sexually transmitted infections), such as gonorrhea and syphilis. Use only water- or silicone-based lubricants; oil-based lubricants can make a condom break.

- PrEP (Pre-Exposure Prophylaxis). If you are HIV-negative and at higher risk for HIV, you might be a candidate for PrEP. PrEP involves an HIV-negative person taking certain HIV drugs to reduce the risk of getting HIV. A person starts PrEP before being exposed to HIV. Talk to your doctor to find out if PrEP might be right for you.

If you use drugs, there are things you can do to protect yourself and practice safer drug use:

- Use a new needle and syringe every time you inject drugs (or steroids or hormones). Get new needles and supplies from your local harm reduction program, needle/syringe program or community health centre.
- Never share drug equipment (such as cookers, filters, water, alcohol swabs, pipes, straws), not even with your partner. Use your own drug equipment every time.

Living With HIV

HIV Treatment

There is no vaccine or cure for HIV.
When combinations of powerful new drugs for antiretroviral therapy (ART) became available in the mid-1990s, HIV treatment was revolutionized. There was a drastic reduction in the number of illnesses experienced by people with HIV and increased survival. ART allowed many people with HIV to return to work and lead a full life.

Newer HIV treatments are safer, simpler and more effective than those available when ART was first introduced. The power of ART today is so profound that a young HIV-positive adult who begins treatment shortly after diagnosis, who takes his/her medicines every day exactly as directed and who has no or few co-existing health conditions is expected to live a near-normal lifespan.

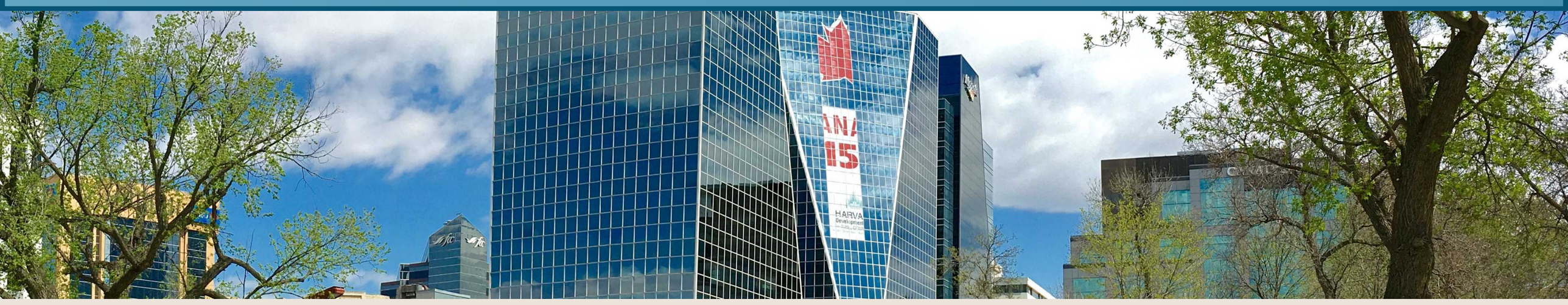
Evidence also shows that HIV-positive people who are on ART, engaged in care, and have an ongoing undetectable viral load are substantially less likely to transmit HIV to others, be it through sex, when sharing equipment to use drugs, or during pregnancy and birth. In fact, the evidence for sexual transmission shows that people on ART who maintain an undetectable viral load do not pass HIV to their sexual partners.

Advanced Stage

AIDS — Acquired Immuno-Deficiency Syndrome

HIV and AIDS are NOT the same thing.

Without HIV treatment, your immune system can become too weak to fight off serious illnesses, and you can eventually become sick with life-threatening infections and cancers. This is called AIDS. However, thanks to effective HIV treatment, these days most people with HIV never get AIDS.



What is HCV?

Hepatitis C Virus

Hepatitis C (HCV) is a virus that is carried in the blood and infects the liver. This causes inflammation and scarring of the liver over a long term period. The liver is a very important organ in your body. It helps the body fight infections, break down toxins (poisons) and drugs, digest food, and more. **You can't live without it.**
Hepatitis A (HAV) and Hepatitis B (HBV) can also affect the liver. These viruses are easy to confuse with HCV.
The main differences are:

- Most people clear HAV and HBV after a period of sickness, but people can have HCV for years without knowing it.
- There are vaccines to protect against HAV and HBV, but there is no vaccine for HCV.

Speed & Transmission

How is HCV Transmitted?

Transmission of HCV occurs through blood-to-blood contact. The virus gets into the blood through breaks in the skin or in the lining of the nose and mouth.
The main ways HCV can get inside the body:

- Re-using drug equipment that was used by someone else. This includes needles, cotton filters, cookers, alcohol swabs, tourniquets, water, pipes for smoking crack or crystal meth, and straws for snorting.
- Re-using tools for piercing and tattooing, including needles, ink and ink pots. Also re-using tools for electrolysis or acupuncture.
- Re-using medical equipment that was meant to be used only once, such as needles for vaccines or medicines, or medical equipment that was not cleaned properly before re-use.
- Sharing or borrowing personal care items that might have blood on them, such as razors, nail clippers and toothbrushes.
- Unprotected sex if there is blood involved (including menstrual blood).
- Getting a blood transfusion or organ transplant that was not screened for HCV. In Canada, donated blood has been screened for HCV since 1990. In some other countries, blood was not able to be screened until more recently.

> HCV is a strong virus: it can live outside of the body for up to 16 days, meaning dried blood can also pass the virus. It can also live up to 9 weeks in a needle. Bleach has not been proven to kill it.

What to Watch for

Signs & Symptoms

Many people can live with HCV for 20-30 years before experiencing symptoms

As the virus progresses, an infected person might start to feel symptoms like:

- Constant fatigue
- Body aches
- Dry, itchy skin
- "Brain fog" (difficulty concentrating, forgetfulness, confusion)
- A noticeable yellowing of skin and eyes (called Jaundice)

Know Your Status

Testing

You can have HCV and not know it. The only way to know is to get tested.
It usually takes two blood tests to tell whether you have HCV.

- The first test (an antibody test) checks to see if you have ever come in contact with the virus.
- A person who has cleared the virus will always test positive for the antibody.
- The second test (a PCR or RNA test) checks to see if you have the infection right now.

Getting Better

Treatment

There are six different strains, or types, of HCV, called genotypes.
Knowing the genotype of your virus is important because some genotypes react better to some treatments than to others.
It is possible to become infected with more than one genotype after multiple exposures to HCV. This can make treatment more difficult.
About 1 in 4 people clear HCV without treatment, but most people need treatment to cure HCV.
The best treatment for HCV:

- Medication will need to be taken from 8–12 weeks, depending on the type of HCV genotype
- Eat a balanced diet
- Follow safer sex, drug, and alcohol practices

> **Re-infection is possible**. A person who had HCV and spontaneously cleared the virus or was cured through treatment can be re-infected if they are exposed to the virus again. HCV antibodies do not protect against the virus.

Our Approach

What is Harm Reduction?

Harm reduction is an evidence-based, client-centered approach that aims to reduce harmful consequences. We engage in harm reduction in our everyday lives to minimize a risk, such as wearing a helmet when riding a bike or enforcing seat belts when driving in a car.

A frequent misconception of harm reduction is that it supports, or encourages substance use. However, harm reduction approaches do not presume a specific outcome, which means that abstinence based interventions can also fall within the spectrum of harm reduction goals. Essentially, harm reduction supports the idea that those with addiction or substance use disorder should be treated with dignity and respect and have a wide selection of treatment options in order to make an informed decision about their individual needs and what would be the most effective for them, while also reducing the harms.

What We Do

How does APSS practice harm reduction?

APSS acknowledges that many individuals coping with substance use disorder may not be in a position to stop using. The harm reduction approach provides an option for users to engage with peers, medical and social services in a non-judgemental way that will "meet them where they are." This allows for a health oriented response to substance use, and it has been proven that those who engage in harm reduction services are more likely to engage in ongoing treatment as a result of accessing these services. Our harm reduction services align with our mission to reduce blood borne infections such as HIV and HCV, and have decreased the rates of deaths due to drug overdoses.

Our harm reduction services include Naloxone training/distribution program. In these programs, we offer information/intervention conversation sessions on topics such as harm reduction, overdose prevention, HIV/HCV/STIs, testing, and treatment in order to enhance skills and knowledge to live safer and healthier lives. These sessions lead to increased knowledge and referrals to testing and treatment.

Harm Reduction

The Queen City Needle Exchange

The Queen City Needle Exchange provides sterile needles and a safe disposal location for used needles. Education on safer practices and keeping used needles out of the community is an important function of our needle exchange program.

Our staff can offer harm reduction counselling regarding sexual health and safer drug use practices and addictions counselling including referrals to treatment.

After Hours: For needle exchange outside our working hours, please contact the Street Project Van at (306) 766-7799.

The Process

How Our Service Works

We provide a safe, confidential, and judgmental-free space to access harm reduction supplies. Here is what you can expect when you visit us:

1. Anonymous ID Setup: To help us track our impact and keep our services running, we will create a unique ID for you. It simply uses your initials, birth month, and birth year—no names or official IDs required.
2. Needle Exchange: You can exchange your used needles for new ones on a 1-to-1 basis. A 10 pack of needles can also be picked up without an exchange.
3. Pipes: One Straight or one bubble pipe per person is only available on Saturday, Sunday, and Monday
4. Harm Reduction Supplies: We offer a full range of safe drug use and safe sex supplies to help protect your health and reduce the transmission of HIV and Hepatitis C.

Supplies

What We Offer

Ten pack of insulin syringes and alcohol swabs

We offer three sizes of containers for used needles. Each container can hold 40 needles (small), 200 needles (medium flip), and 400 needles (large).

Glass stem pipe, brass screen filters, alcohol swab

Glass "bubble" pipe, alcohol swab

We have drug testing strips available. Packages come with strips to test for Fentanyl, Benzodiazepines, and Xylazine

HIV Self-Test Kits

Naloxone Kit

Stay Safe

Safer Injecting: Harm Reduction Tips

Staying safe means taking a few extra moments to protect your body. Keep these five rules in mind:

1. Clean Start:
   - Always use a brand-new needle. Wipe your skin with an alcohol swab before you inject (not after).
2. Clean Mix:
   - Use a fresh cooker and sterile water every single time to prevent infections and endocarditis (heart lining infection).
3. Aim Toward the Heart:
   - Inject in the direction of your blood flow (toward the heart). Take your time and inject slowly.
4. Protect Vulnerable Areas:
   - Stick to arms and hands. Avoid high-risk areas like the neck, head, groin, or genitals, and rotate your spots.
5. Dispose Safely:
   - Keep used needles out of public spaces. Put them in a sharps container and bring them to us for safe disposal.

Community Safety

Community Safety: Safe Needle Disposal

📮 Don't want to touch it? No problem. Report the needle online at www.reportneedles.ca or call The Street Project at (306) 766-7799 and a team member will come collect it.

If you choose to dispose of the needle yourself, protect yourself by following these steps:

- Prep: Place a hard, unbendable container (like a coffee tin or pop bottle) on a flat surface.
- Pick Up: Use pliers or tongs. Hold the needle by the plastic barrel, keeping the sharp point facing away from you.
- Leave the Cap Off: Do not attempt to recap the needle.
- Drop & Seal: Put it in the container and close the lid tightly.
- Clean: Wash your hands with soap and water.
- Dispose: Keep the container away from children and take it to a designated needle disposal drop box.

Safe Sex Education

Safer Sex Basics

No matter what sex you are participating in, make sure you do it safe!

Protection

Condoms

Condoms protect against both STIs and pregnancy. When used consistently and properly, they can significantly reduce your chances of passing or receiving a STI.
There are two types of condoms, external condoms (male) and internal condoms (female).

Condoms

- A new condom should be used every time you have sexual intercourse. From the moment the penis comes in contact with the vagina, anus, or mouth, until there is no more contact.
- Carefully unwrap the condom checking to make sure it is not damaged.
- Use water-based lubricant to prevent breakage (oil-based lubes can cause a condom to break).
- Never reuse a condom.

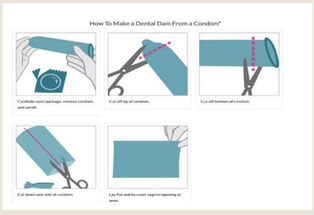
Common Condom Use Mistakes:

- Unrolling a condom before putting it on
- No space at the tip
- Putting on two condoms at once
- Wrong size condom
- Not removing the air from the tip
- Improper storage
- Wrong lubricant

Barrier Method

Dental Dams

- Barrier methods of protection, like a dental dam, can greatly reduce your risk of transmitting or receiving an STI through oral sex.
- Dental dams can be used for oral sex performed on the vulva or anus.
- Dental dams can be made from unrolling an external condom, cutting the tip off and cutting down the side.



Know the Difference

Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs)

- Sexually Transmitted Diseases (STDs) are now called Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs). This is because disease means being sick and having symptoms, while infection means you may not show anything but still pass the sickness onto another person.
- Most STIs are caused by germs (bacteria or viruses) that are passed from one person to another during sex or intimate contact.

- STIs caused by bacteria can be cured with a short course of antibiotics. If diagnosed and treated soon after infection, a bacterial STI is generally less likely to cause damage to the body.
- STIs caused by viruses cannot be cured with antibiotics, but the symptoms can be managed with medication.
- STI testing can help find an infection early. If you know that you have an infection, you can get treatment and prevent spreading the infection to others. Left untreated, some STIs can lead to serious problems.

Common STIs

Types & Symptoms

- STIs Caused by Bacteria

Chlamydia

Signs & Symptoms

- Burning during urination
- Unusual discharge from the vagina, urethra or anus
- Itching of the groin area

If symptoms do occur, they usually take two to three weeks to appear, but they can also take up to six weeks. Chlamydia can also infect the throat.

Treatment: Can be cured with antibiotics. If left untreated, it has been known to cause infertility.

Gonorrhea

Signs & Symptoms

- If symptoms do occur, they often appear two to seven days after infection. Gonorrhea can also infect the throat.
- Treatment: Can be cured with antibiotics. However, some strains of Gonorrhea have become resistant to some antibiotics. If left untreated, it can cause serious health problems such as infertility, pelvic inflammatory pain, and chronic pelvic pain.

Syphilis

Signs & Symptoms

- If symptoms do occur, they can take anywhere from three to 90 days to appear.
- Treatment: Can be cured by antibiotics. If untreated, it can cause damage to the heart, the brain, and other organs.

STIs Caused by Viruses

Herpes Simplex Virus (HSV)

There are two types of HSV:

- HSV-1 – "Cold Sores" – sores around the mouth (these can be hereditary)
- HSV-2- Genital HSV – sores on the genitals

Signs & Symptoms

- Painful blisters that turn into open sores on the skin

If symptoms do occur, they can take anywhere from two to 21 days to appear. People can pass HSV even if they do not have outbreaks.

Treatment: There is no vaccine to prevent herpes and no cure, but medication can help reduce the number and severity of outbreaks.

Human Papillomavirus (HPV)

Signs & Symptoms

- Genital warts

If symptoms do occur, they can take months or years to appear.

Treatment: Most cases of HPV clear on their own within two years. There is a vaccine that protects against HPV and they are best taken before a person becomes sexually active. There is no cure for HPV but there is treatment to deal with the warts. Genital warts can be treated by freezing or putting medication on the skin. Some strains of HPV can eventually lead to cancers of the cervix, vagina, vulva, anus, penis or throat.

Client Care Program

HIV Positive Client Care

Just found out you have HIV? Here is how we can help:

- Connect you to the Infectious Disease Clinic and Public Health
- Meet you at a location of your choosing to discuss your health concerns
- Advocate for you
- Refer you to other agencies or medical professionals if needed
- Transport and accompany you to appointments and give you appointment reminders
- Alleviate your fears and educate you on what comes next
- Visit you in hospital and at home
- Complete confidentiality

- The Client Care program works directly with people living with HIV/AIDS. It is built upon the understanding that the capacity to manage and maintain health while living with HIV/AIDS is determined, in part, by factors such as income level, housing, access to care, access to health services, access to quality health care, and individual coping skills.

- Our Client Care Coordinator works in conjunction with individuals to determine personal needs and together design supportive plans including: practical needs (food, clothing), health services (transportation, education, medication, and nutrition), support (counseling, alternative treatments), help with housing and referrals to other agencies.

- Our Client Care Coordinator provides support on a one to one basis. Our coordinator makes home visits, hospital visits, plans social activities with client and meets the client where they are at. If clients wish to disclose their positive status to individuals, our coordinator aids in facilitating the conversation while debunking myths and enhancing education around HIV/AIDS.

- Jerome Nagel and Ric Ranger Wellness Fund
  Through this fund, our Client Care Coordinator can provide financial support including help with medication, transportation, infant formula, and psychological counselling.

- Contact our Client Care Coordinator at (306) 924-8420 for more information.

Client Story

- Below is a client video story. This video tells the story of Charles Redwood's recovery from sexual abuse, addictions, incarceration and HIV to eventual sobriety and dealing with shame. It also details how we managed to help him on his journey to recovery. It is an inspiring story of courage, faith and dealing with a life's journey that was anything but easy. Charles tells his story simply and in a straightforward manner. It is an inspiring message to us all.

Video W.I.P

HIV/STI Testing

APSS offers free HIV and STI tests that can be done at a location that APSS provides or APSS members can come to you in order to test you for any STI and/or HIV.

These are always free of charge and we might end up also giving you some special kits to test for whether you get HIV in the future. You can use the form below to book an appointment to get tested for either HIV or STI and we will make sure to accommodate you in the best way possible

Enter your name:	
Which test did you want:	
Enter your Email:	

Submit

After filling out this form you will be sent an email with details regarding the time you should come at and if there are any special precautions you have to take to come, after receiving the email come at the designated time and we will be more than happy to serve you!

Opioid Support

APSS Opioid Overdose Prevention Program

If you or someone you know is using opioids and would benefit from extra support, here is how we can help:

- Connect you with our Peer Support Worker
- Assist in getting you in addictions treatment and recovery programs
- Help with housing, food, and clothing
- Refer you to other agencies or medical professionals if needed
- Alleviate your fears and educate you on what comes next
- Advocate for you
- Complete confidentiality

Our Opioid Overdose Prevention Program employs a Registered Social Worker as a Client Care Coordinator to assist those using opioids while living in the community. The Client Care Coordinator supports and connects clients with appropriate resources to help address their needs. This includes, but is not limited to, housing supports, physical and mental health supports, addictions treatment and recovery programs, food and clothing resources and a peer support worker.

The Client Care Coordinator works with clients using a harm reduction approach to educate clients on the risks associated with opioid use, and how to respond in an overdose situation.

The goal of the AOOPP is to help address the overdose crisis we are currently facing. By providing education, client care and peer support, we hope to reduce the amount of opioid overdose hospitalizations and deaths, while increasing naloxone training and kit distribution and referrals to recovery programs.

Contact

Contact our Peer Support Coordinator:
Email: peersupport@apssregina.ca
Phone: (306) - 924 8420
Toll Free: 1-877-210-7623

Community Support

Support Groups

Anyone At-Risk Support Group

The At Risk Support Group is led by Elder Janet Dufour and Danita Wahpoosewyan.

At Risk meets every Thursday at 5:00pm at All Nations Hope, supported by AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan Inc.

The Elder provides some teaching each week, and each week clients have an opportunity to share and discuss what is going on in their lives during a talking circle.

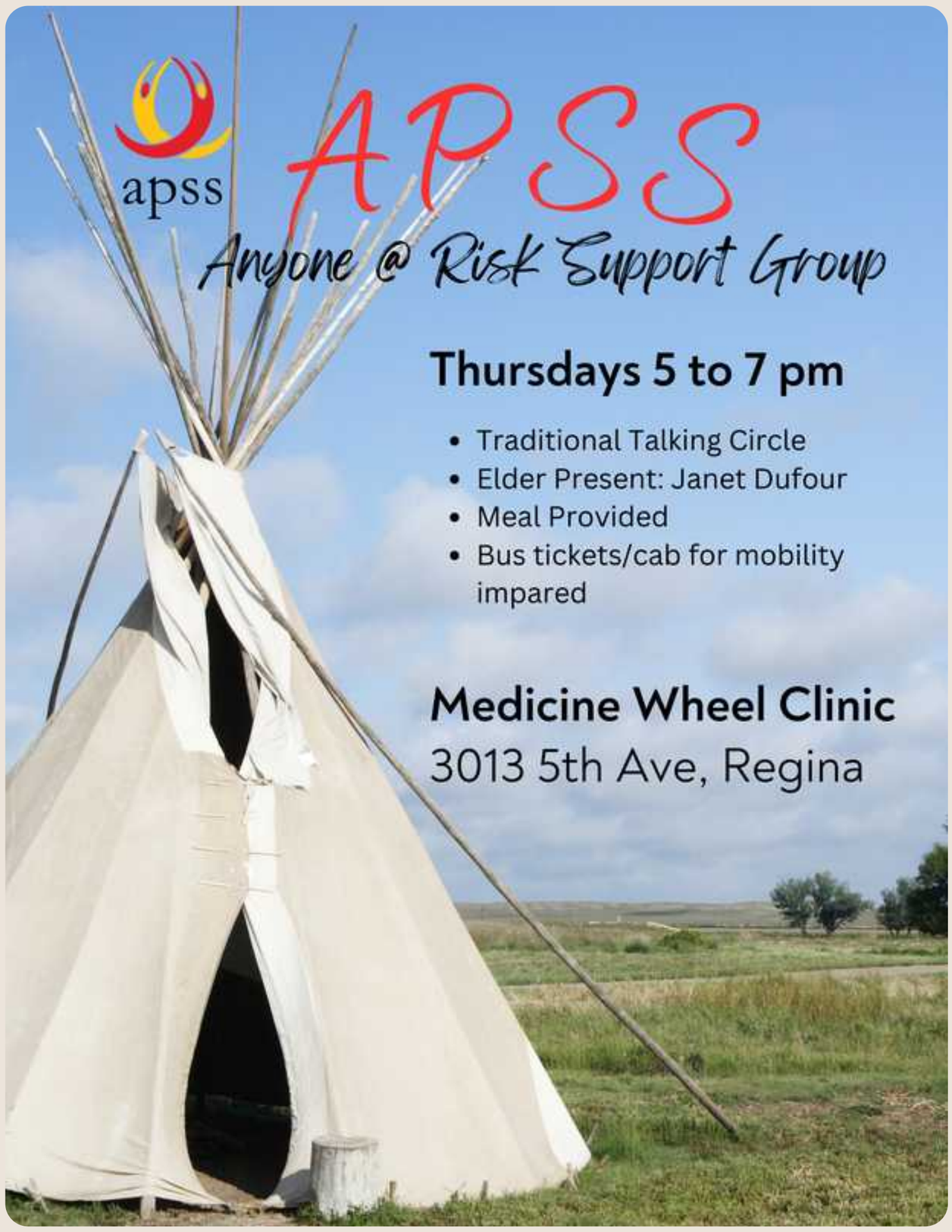
Everyone is welcome to attend. Rides can be provided as needed. Refreshments and snacks are provided.

📅 Every Thursday
5:00pm

📌 All Nations Hope
Regina

🚗 Rides Available
as needed

☕ Refreshments
Snacks provided



Ways to Donate

Your contribution helps us stop the spread of HIV/AIDS and HCV, counselling, nutritional needs, transportation, the opportunity to sit down over coffee and talk about the client's care plan and other concerns, as well as covering costs for medications for other health concerns not covered by Saskatchewan Government.

Online

Donate through our confidential and secure online donation services. You can donate one time or monthly. Your tax receipt will come from Canada Helps, as they are facilitating your donation, but the receipt will reference AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan.

Cash/Cheque

If you would like to write us a cheque, please address it to AIDS Programs South Saskatchewan and write "donation" on the designation line.

Basic Necessities

We also accept lightly used clothing and hygiene products (shampoo, conditioner, feminine products, tooth brushes, tooth paste, non-alcoholic mouthwash, etc.) to distribute to our clients in need.

Large Donations

For corporate, legacy, or donations over $25,000, please contact our Executive Director, Vidya Reddy at 306-924-8420.

Host a Fundraiser on our Behalf

If you are interested in hosting a fundraiser to benefit APSS, contact Erin Hidlebaugh at 306-924-8420.

BECOME a Volunteer

Thank you for your interest in volunteering and supporting APSS.

We could not carry out our mission without the hard work and support of our volunteers. You are the force that drives the hope of eradicating HIV and HCV in our communities!

If you are interested in volunteering with us, please complete the volunteer application form and email it to programs@apssregina.ca.

Volunteers Are Needed In The Following Areas

Needle Exchange Program

Assist our Needle Exchange Coordinator at our Needle Exchange. Spaces are limited and are more available in the summer.

Must be 18 to volunteer.

Packing Parties

Help us to package condoms, Needle Exchange supplies, stamping pamphlets, and so much more! Call for information.

Education Services

Assist our Education Team at education information tables and presenting presentations. Opportunities for education information tables are available in the summer while presentations to schools, correctional facilities, universities, and community centres are throughout the year.

Special Events

This is a great way to help out the organization if you cannot commit to regular volunteering hours. Throughout the year, we have a few awareness events as well as our annual fundraising event:

- The Annual AIDS Benefit — held at the GLCR the Saturday evening closest to December 1st

APSS Events

In Celebration of Worlds AIDS Day

World AIDS Day is held on December 1st each year and is an opportunity for people worldwide to unite in the fight against HIV, show their support for people living with HIV and to commemorate the people who have died.
The first World AIDS Day was held in 1988 and it was the first ever global health day.

Why is Worlds AIDS Day Important?

Globally an estimated 34 million people have HIV. More than 35 million people have died from the virus, making it one of the most destructive pandemics in history.
Today, many scientific advances have been made in HIV treatment, there are laws to protect people living with HIV and we understand so much more about the virus.
Though despite this, people do not know the facts about how to protect themselves and others from HIV, and stigma and discrimination remain a reality for many people living with HIV.

What should I Do On Worlds AIDS Day?

World AIDS Day is an opportunity for you to learn the facts about HIV and put your knowledge into action.

You can also show your support for people living with HIV by wearing a red ribbon, the international symbol of HIV awareness and support.

World AIDS Day is also a great opportunity to raise money for your local AIDS organization and show your support for people living with HIV.

Our Location

AIDS Program South Saskatchewan Inc.

1325 Albert Street,
Regina, SK S4R 2R6

Phone & Email

All calls are confidential.

Phone: (306) 924-8420
Toll Free: 1-877-210-7623
Email: admin@apssregina.ca

Hours of Operation

We're here to help during the following hours

Mon - Fri: 9:00 a.m. - 12:00 p.m. & 1:00 p.m. - 4:30 p.m.
Sat: 10:00 a.m. - 4:30 p.m.
Sun: 11:00 a.m. - 4:00 p.m

Get in Touch

We're Here to Help

Reach out by phone, email, or the form below. All contact with APSS is confidential, and our staff will get back to you as soon as possible.

Get in touch

Contact us Today

We'd love to hear from you! Whether you want to volunteer, support our programs, or learn more about our services.

First name *
First Name

Last name *
Last Name

Subject *
Subject

Email Address *
Email Address

Message *
Message

Submit Message

Our Location

Where to Find Us